

Godagama 10200 Urbanization Evidence Report

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Date: 2026-06-27

Prepared from the Google-derived POI extract, OSM/ohsome history, UDA/RDA planning evidence, and developer market signals.

What changed in this version

The earlier coordinate scatter chart was not useful because one extracted POI had a bad longitude outside Sri Lanka, which stretched the axis. This version filters geospatial outliers for charts, replaces the raw scatter with a local map view, and adds comparison visuals designed for print.

Data quality note

- Raw Google-derived POI rows: **3,495**.
- Rows used for numeric analysis after removing non-Sri-Lanka coordinate outliers: **3,494**.
- Removed geospatial outliers: **1**.
- POIs with earliest visible activity/photo dates: **3,384**.
- The earliest-visible date is an activity proxy, not a confirmed opening date.

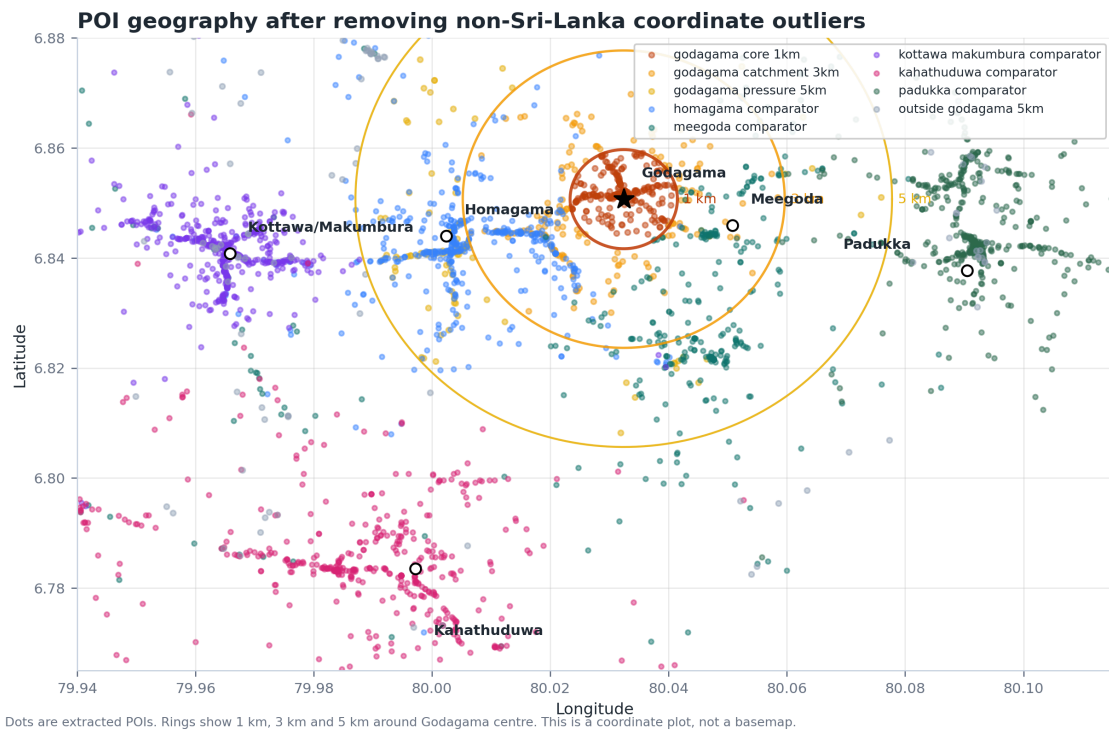
Executive findings

1. **Godagama has a dense core and a thinner surrounding catchment.** The 3 km catchment has **440 POIs (15.6/km²)**, but the 1 km core alone has **274 POIs**, about **87.2/km²**.
2. **The current Godagama POI layer is recent.** **82.4%** of dated Godagama POIs were first visible from **2021 onward**, the highest recent-share among the six comparator areas in this extract.
3. **The property/developer signal is already material.** Godagama has **63 property/developer POIs** in the 3 km catchment, **14.3%** of its extracted POI base. That share is close to Homagama and Kottawa/Makumbura.
4. **The strongest comparator pressure is Kahathuduwa, followed by Meegoda and Kottawa/Makumbura.** The pressure score ranks: **Kahathuduwa (72.2)**, **Meegoda**

(57.6), Kottawa/Makumbura (53.6), Godagama (34.5), Padukka (31.2), Homagama (21.0).

5. **OpenStreetMap history shows physical growth ahead of full commercial maturity.** In the Godagama-area OSM bounding box, mapped buildings rose **+338%** from 2018 to 2026, while mapped road length rose **+33%**. That is consistent with subdivision/build-out happening before the commercial layer fully fills in.

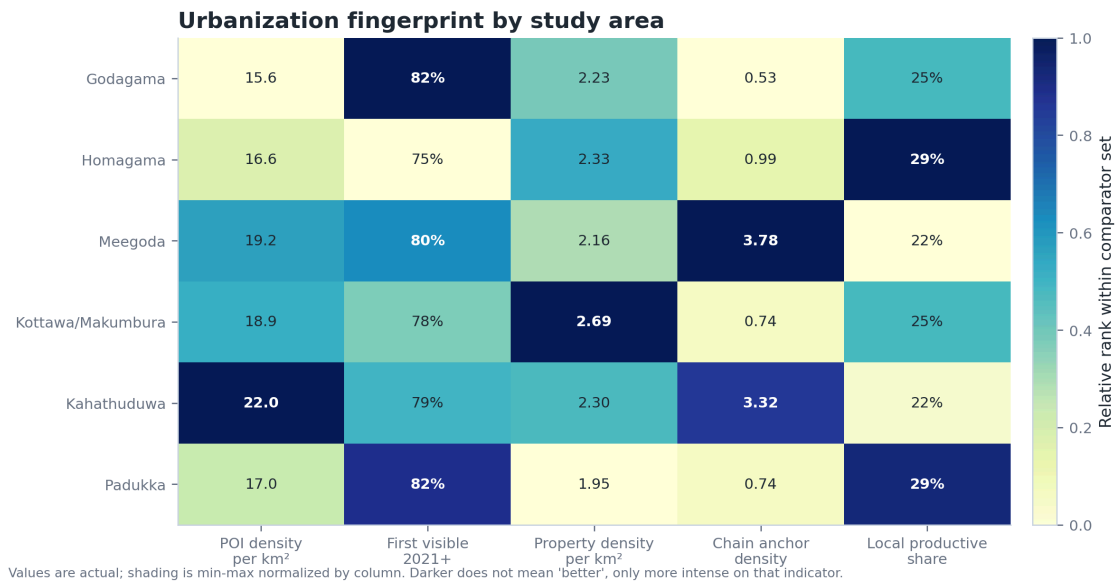
Study geography



Clean local POI geography

Comparator fingerprint

This is the main diagnostic chart. Darker cells show which areas are high on each measured indicator; values printed inside the cells are the actual values.



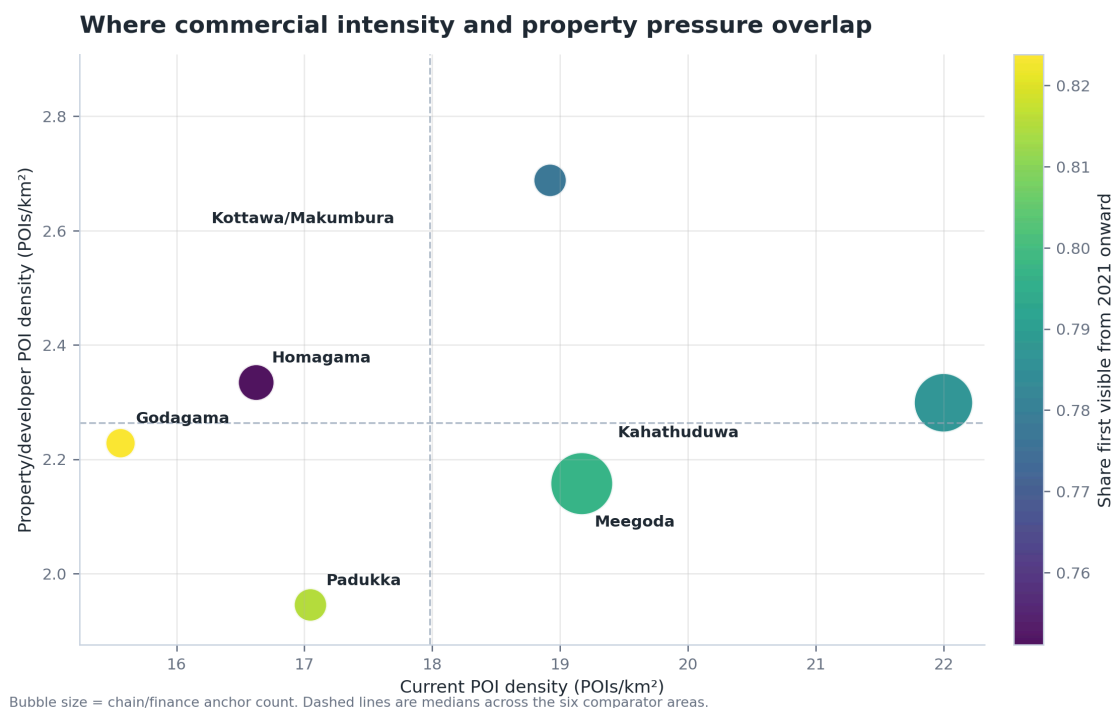
Urbanization fingerprint

Pressure model

The model is not a land-price forecast. It is a triage index for where urbanization pressure is most visible in the current data.

Inputs:

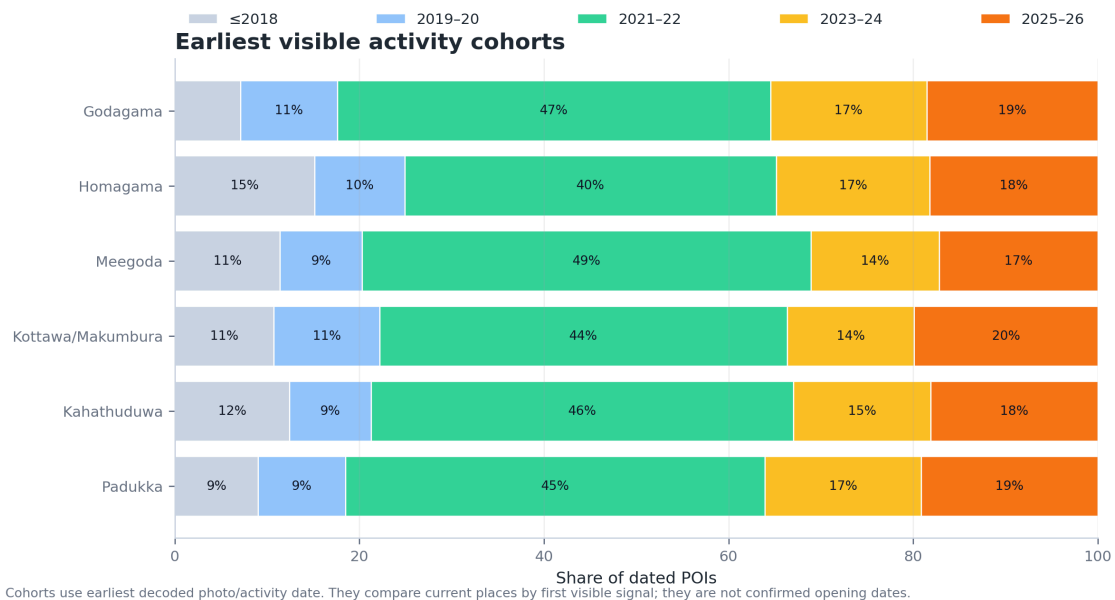
- 35% current POI density;
- 25% share of POIs first visible from 2021 onward;
- 25% property/developer POI density;
- 15% chain/finance anchor density.



Pressure scatter

Area	POIs	POIs/km ²	Visible 2021+	Property share	Property POIs	Productive-service POIs	Score
Godagama	440	15.6	82.4%	14.3%	63	111	34.5
Homagama	470	16.6	75.1%	14.0%	66	137	21.0
Meegoda	542	19.2	79.7%	11.3%	61	117	57.6
Kottawa/Makumbura	535	18.9	77.8%	14.2%	76	135	53.6
Kahathuduwa	622	22.0	78.7%	10.5%	65	136	72.2
Padukka	482	17.0	81.5%	11.4%	55	138	31.2

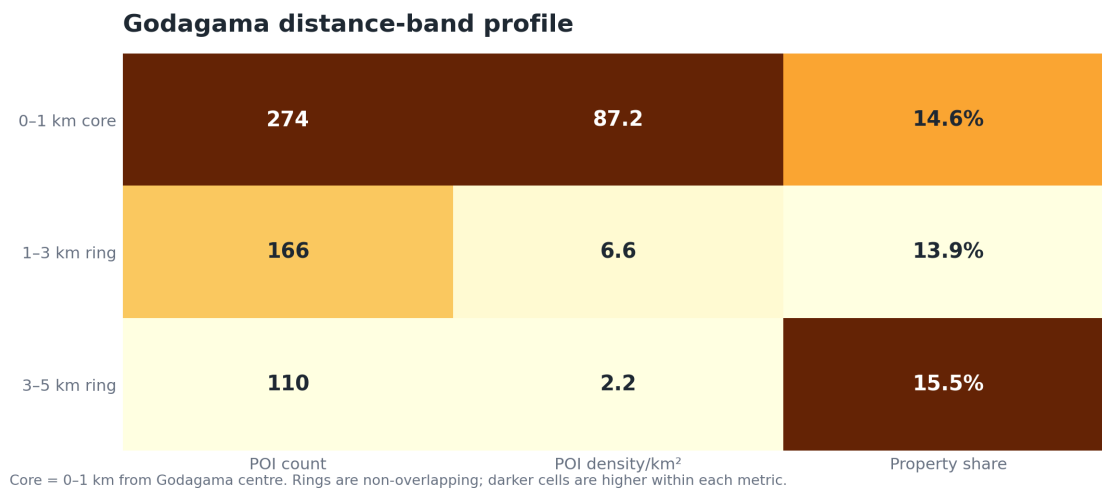
Timeline signal



Activity cohorts

The 2021–2022 band is large across all areas. Treat it as a combined real activity + Google photo coverage signal. The comparison remains useful because the same extraction method is applied to each area.

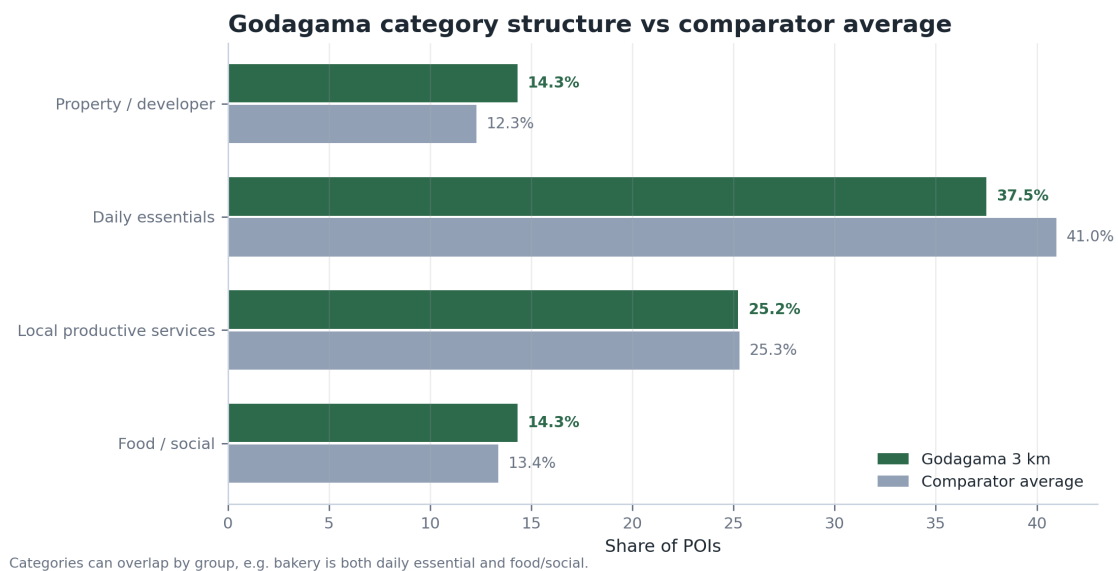
Godagama distance-band structure



Godagama rings

The 1 km core carries most of the visible density. The planning implication is that Godagama should be treated as a town-centre management problem in the core and a growth-guidance problem in the 1–5 km rings.

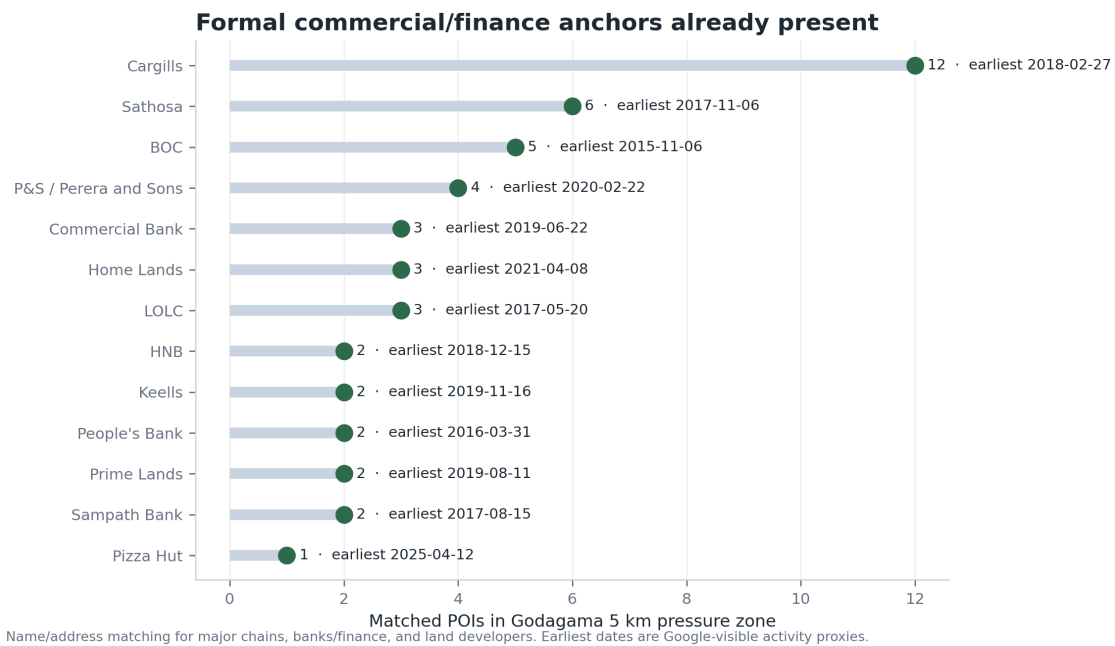
Category structure



Category groups

Godagama is not only a food or commuting suburb. The extracted mix shows daily essentials, clinics, hardware, vehicle service, electronics, courier, apartments, and land development. That supports a local-enterprise framing rather than a single-sector framing.

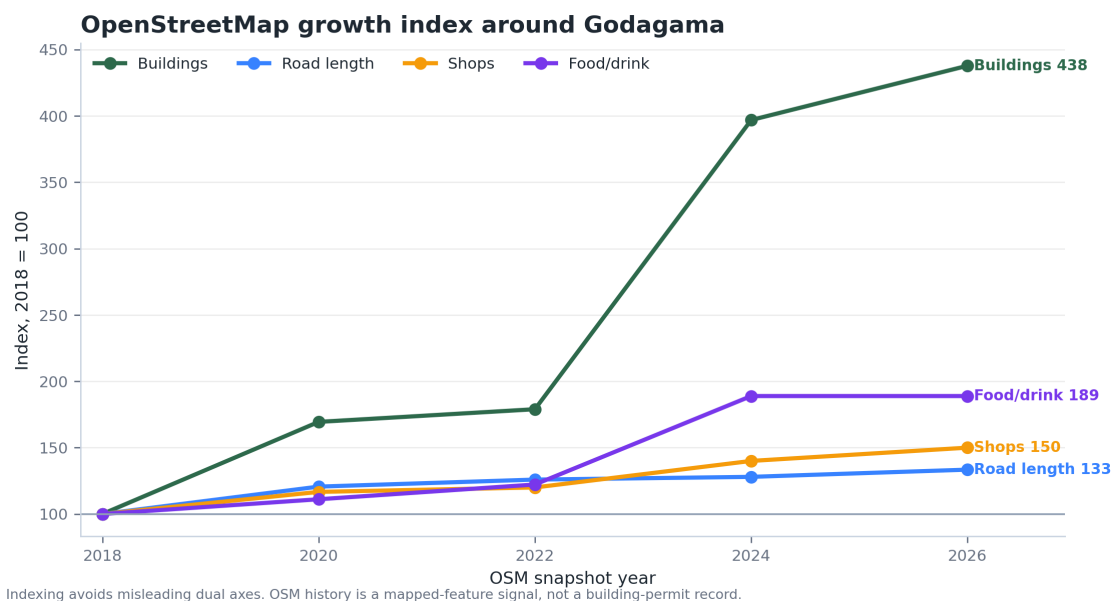
Chain, finance, and developer anchors



Chain anchors

Anchor	Matched POIs in Godagama 5 km	Earliest visible date
Cargills	12	2018-02-27
Sathosa	6	2017-11-06
BOC	5	2015-11-06
P&S / Perera and Sons	4	2020-02-22
Commercial Bank	3	2019-06-22
Home Lands	3	2021-04-08
LOLC	3	2017-05-20
HNB	2	2018-12-15
Keells	2	2019-11-16
People's Bank	2	2016-03-31
Prime Lands	2	2019-08-11
Sampath Bank	2	2017-08-15
Pizza Hut	1	2025-04-12

Physical growth baseline from OSM



OSM growth index

OSM history is not a building-permit record, but the magnitude and direction are useful: building mapping and road/subdivision mapping increased strongly from 2018 to 2026.

Planning facts to carry into meetings

Fact	Evidence	Use
Godagama has official commercial intensification status	UDA plan identifies Godagama as High-Density Commercial Zone III	Treat growth as planned intensification, not accidental sprawl
Kahathuduwa has stronger interchange-led status	UDA plan identifies Kahathuduwa as High-Density Commercial Zone II and guide-plan area	Use Kahathuduwa as the comparator for what Godagama may become next
Environmental constraints are formal planning layers	Wetland Nature Conservation Zone and Paddy/Wetland Agricultural Zone in the UDA plan	Use protect / guide / intensify zones instead of blanket approval
Developer market signals track highway access	Prime Lands and Home Lands project pages market access to Kottawa, Makumbura, Athurugiriya, Kahathuduwa, Mirigama	Use developer POIs and land-price/project data as early-warning indicators

Data-driven planning suggestions

- Core 0–1 km:** manage as a town centre. Priorities: crossings, drainage, frontage rules, parking/loading, shade, small-shop continuity.
- Ring 1–3 km:** reserve room for local productive services: hardware, repair, vehicle service, electronics, courier, clinics, food, bakeries, plant/garden businesses.

3. **Ring 3–5 km:** require drainage, paddy/wetland screening, road-connectivity review, and developer contribution before large approvals.
4. **Quarterly monitoring:** rerun the POI extraction and compare Godagama's score against Kahathuduwa and Kottawa/Makumbura.
5. **Next data pass:** decode review count/first review date, collect official opening dates for the top 200 anchors, and add land-price-per-perch data for land-development POIs.

Files

- Source POI CSV: `urbanization/data/google_maps_godagama_pois.csv`
- OSM baseline: `urbanization/data/godagama-osm-ohsome-baseline-2026-06-26.csv`
- Build script: `urbanization/scripts/build_public_visual_report.py`
- This report: `urbanization/reports/godagama-urbanization-public-report-2026-06-27.pdf`